Jan

MOUNTAINEER

WINTER 1997 Volume 2 Issue 2







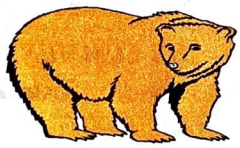
WHEN OLD MAN WINTER BLOWS

HERE'S A TIP

Roland Siushansian

When we are ready to leave our house here in Coolfont we turn off the main water valve and then go to the lowest level bathrooms and open the faucet so that the water can drain from the pipes. This way, if there is a break in the pipe, there is no water to go into the house. This is also a good time to check your toilets before you turn your water on. If the water level is low in your tank, that means you have a leak in your toilet and are losing a precious commodity. Please make sure you get it fixed.

This is our first article in our Neighbor to Neighbor series. Please feel free to send an article to us. We'd love to hear from you.



GREETINGS FROM BEAR'S DEN

Kitty Connor

December 1996 Gale and I celebrated our eighth anniversary as members of Coolfont Mountainside Association.

Remembering our visits to Berkeley Springs with my parents in the 60's, motivated a friend and me to spend a weekend in December of 1988 at Coolfont. While taking a walk around Mountainside, we encountered a woman, who with her husband, had recently purchased a home. Her ebullience was contagious. I never forgot our conversation. The following fall, my husband and I rented a home for a weekend. Enchantment with the mountain was overwhelming and before we returned to Baltimore on Sunday, we had purchased K-6. We moved in on December 15th and were invited to dinner at our neighbors at K-7. To my surprise, our hostess was the woman who I had met during our walk the previous year—Leila Keese! Leila and Emmette have become dear friends. Over the years we have developed many close friendships with other owners. We also treasure the beauty of Mountainside: the woodpeckers, hummingbirds, deer and bear, and especially the winter wonderland following a wet snowfall.

Despite problems indigenous to every community, we recognize the challenges of working together as we live in this nurturing environment of friendship and natural beauty.

We wish everyone a happy and healthy New Year.

BOARD MEMBER CORNER

Each newsletter, a member of the Board of Directors will have a column here to write about something of interest to them and the community. Our second guest writer is Lee Weinberger

In 1990 Greta came to Coolfont to visit some friends who had rented a house for the weekend. After her enthusiastic report, she and Lee came back and bought a lot. They built their home in 1992 - with lots of bedrooms and bathrooms for visits from their three children and six grandchildren. Lee retired (for the second time) in 1996 and they became full time residents.

Lee's career was as a professional engineer; he holds a Ph.D from MIT in sanitary and environmental engineering. Even though he has "officially" retired, Lee loves to work. He is putting his background to good use by heading up the installation of the new CMA water system. Most mornings you will find Lee and Gale Connor consulting in their "office" about the water system.

The Weinbergers have been married for 46 years. Greta gave up a budding singing career to marry Lee. She is an expert needlepoint artist and is the owner of "The Needle and Eye" in Berkeley Springs. Greta is an avid Ma Jong player and would love to get a group going here on the mountainside.

The Weinberger's are a great addition to our community.

SPECIAL EVENTS

MAKE SURE THAT YOUR CALENDAR IS MARKED FOR THE FALL OF 1997 TO HELP US CELEBRATE COOLFONT MOUNTAINSIDE ASSOCIATION'S TWENTY-FIFTH ANNIVERSARY. CONTACT EVA LEHMAN IF YOU WOULD LIKE TO HELP [301-229-3264]

COMMITTEE UPDATES

Here's where you can read about what's been going on with the various committees.

THE COMMUNICATIONS COMMITTEE:
Rosemary Bigelow

The Communications Committee has, with this issue, published two newsletters, put out a new membership telephone directory and devised a newcomer's packet of information which is sent out by the CMA Administrator, Bob Lemon You will notice that the directory is in a protective cover to make it more durable. We plan to issue updates only to the directory, which should make it less expensive and easier to maintain. We have also tried to add more information, such as e-mail addresses and what type of work our members do. Please send your updates and corrections to Mary Ann Siushansian. A special thanks to Mary Ann for the hard work and special touches she gave to the directory, including the pretty color cover.

THE FINANCE COMMITTEE
Bob Dowling

All the members of the Finance Committee who worked so hard over the last several years to raise the necessary funds for the upgrade are now enjoying seeing the construction progress. Thanks to all of you who helped. The next piece of work is to prepare the budget for the next fiscal year. Call Bob Dowling if you want to help.

Happy New Year.

A VIEW FROM THE PRESIDENT

Dear Mountainside Neighbors,

As we head into 1997, the association is indebted to a number of volunteers for their outstanding hard work and gifts of time, brains, heart and energy. We owe thanks to all the committee and subcommittee chairs, of course, along with the board and officers, and those of you without current title but with current interest and involvement who have eagerly participated in our truly interactive community organization!

One of the legacies we are left from all those volunteers who have come before us is an understanding of how much difference one person's efforts can make to our community. When we look around the mountainside and see a beautiful gate area, a lovely swimming pool, tennis courts, an environmentally sensitive water treatment system, and a hundred other improvements, we see the vision and efforts of a small group of individuals working together. If there were no other reason to be active in CMA, that joy of creating could well be enough for many residents here.

Now, we need the help of all CMA members. We will be finished with the largest phase of the water upgrade project soon, and will begin looking at the mountainside to solve a number of other continuing problems.

Chief among these problems are our roads. As the Winters gets wetter and wetter, it will come as no surprise to many of you that water can rush down your driveway on the wettest days and pour across CMA roads, often washing large ruts in them. CMA will need to solve the ditch capacity and construction/repair issues along our big roads; but driveways remain the responsibility of the homeowner.

Over the next few months, we will survey our roads as well as many of these driveway ditches, and make individual recommendations for what they are: an effort to solve a continuing problem that affects all of us, and which can be solved by working together as a community.

In my opinion, your constant willingness to do so is one of the mountainside's best assets.

Happy New Year

Jackson

(Ccmmittee updates continued)

RECREATION COMMITTEE
Charlie Balkan

After meeting for four hours and lots of lively discussions, the recreation committee made up of Kitty Connor, Alice Minammon, Henry Lynn and Charlie Balkan, came to the conclusion that, aside from minor changes, the pool policy should remain essentially the same. We talked about changing rooms, showers, safety, requiring I-D's and charges for use of the facilities. One change will involve replacing the old ID system of green and red tags with a new laminated ID card system. Look for details in your February water bill! Not discussed were trails, the barn and blue bird houses to be purchased by February for the following Spring.

SAFETY COMMITTEE
Elmer Broxson

At the first meeting of the new Board it was decided to set up an Ad Hoc Safety Committee with Elmer Broxson (202-333-8872) serving as chairman and Carroll Yingling (410-744-9332) as Board liason. Its primary tasks are to monitor and advise the Board about fire safety and security guard arrangements, which are currently under contract with CRI. Full-time resident Gale Connor (304-258-3975) has served as CMA contact for CRI for many years and has agreed to continue. Should you have any safety concerns or suggestions please contact one of us.

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GENERAL INFO

Please make sure that any letters for CMA are sent to our PO Box. The address is:

PO Box 418
Berkeley Springs WV 25411

If you would like to have a copy of the Board of Directors minutes, please contact:

Bob Lemon
PO Box 418
Berkeley Springs, WV 25411
304-258-2007

IMPORTANT DATES TO REMEMBER

The Board of Directors has set the dates for the meetings for the year. Please mark your calendars and we hope to see you at some of these meetings. All meetings will be held in Coolfont at various members homes. Please call any of the Board members to find out where the meetings are going to be held. There will be some kind of social event after most board meetings.

Feb. 8 10:00
Yingling residence (J-2)
Pot luck at Bain residence (E-7)

Mar. 8 10:00
Dring residence (O-1)
Pot luck Yingling residence (J-2)

Apr. 12 10:00
Tree Tops
Social event to be announced

May 10 10:00
Place to be announced

June 14 10:00
Place to be announced

July 19 9:00 Board meeting
Place to be announced
Annual meeting 1:00
Treetops



IS WATER GOLD?

Gale Connor

"We just received our water bill. You people must have a problem with your water system. There has to be a leak in the line or the water meter is broken."

"I won't pay this water bill! There has to be a leak in the water line. There is no way that we could possibly have used that much water in a three month period."

The complaints are coming in, as some water bills climb. As hard as it may be to accept, 99+% of a high water bill is the result of a problem inside the house. The problem might be:

*Toilet tank leaking
*Faucet dripping
*Renters, who don't know the cost of our water
*A leak in the water line between the meter and the house

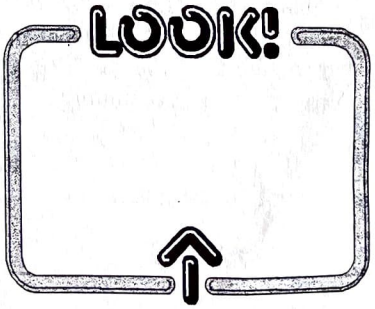
Any of these potential problems can and do lead to high water bills. Most of us assume that the problem is within the water meter. It's not the meter. Every water meter that CMA has had calibrated has shown that the meter is registering less water than is actually passing through the meter. The people who calibrate our meters tell us this is true of all the meters they test.

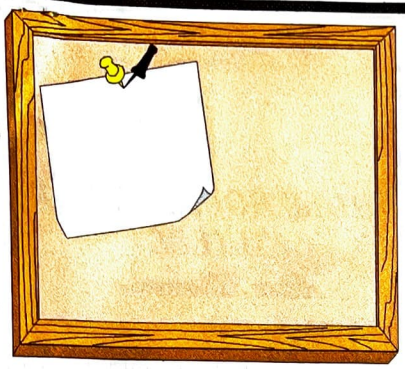
Don't wait until you receive "sticker shock" from a water bill. Take steps to insure that you are not paying for water that you did not use. Take the time to check the faucets and toilets for leaks. If you do not use your home on a regular basis, contract with someone to check your house for you. Find your water meter and make a habit of reading the meter. By keeping track of the meter readings you should be able to detect a leak.

Practicing water leak prevention will save you money, as well as our community water supply.

EYES OPEN

One of our members has reported the theft of a significant amount of firewood from his woodpile, though far less than a truckload. Please keep your eyes open for anyone loading or transporting firewood that is not coming from his own property and call such action to the attention of any member of the board.





COMMUNITY BULLETIN BOARD

Do you have some news that the community would like to know, is your house or lot for sale, are you celebrating a big event? Let us know. Get in touch with Mary Ann Siushansian to put your news here.

If you know someone who would like to purchase a lot and /or home here in Coolfont, here's what's for sale:

HOUSES FOR SALE

Q-9 Montebello.....$196,500
K-15 Shalom.....$135,000
I-2 &I-3 Brickless.. $174,900
E-1 Tamarack.....$119,500
K-8 Fox's Den.....$144,900
B-5 & B-4 Katydid...$ 99,500
L-1 Canaan.....$109,560

LOTS FOR SALE

E-3.....$ 33,000
H-1.....$47,500
I-3.....$30,000
K-1.....$42,500
K-2.....$38,000
K-1 & K-2.....$78,000
K-14.....$45,000
Q-7.....$47,000
S-6.....$68,950

Homeowners who rent privately and have expressed interest in joining together for advertising and referrals should call Eva Lehman.

WHAT'S HAPPENING IN BERKELEY SPRINGS

Rosemary Bigelow

For the last seven years Travel Berkeley Springs has produced the Winter Festival of the Waters to provide special events during the winter months after the holidays. Most of these events highlight West Virginia and its products. I've found many of these activities to be quite enjoyable and I'd recommend you try a couple. The Festival of the Waters even includes a water tasting and competition. Below are a few of the highlights, but for a complete calendar contact Travel Berkeley Springs at 800-447-8797.

***If candlelit gourmet dinners in front of a fireplace appeal to you, try the special wine and dine weekends at High Lawn Inn Feb. 15and March 29 and Saturday evenings May-Oct. The wines are provided by Fisher Ridge, a West Virginia winery. Reservations are a must, call 258-5700.

***The weekend of Feb. 21-23 is filled with water tasting events including the International Water Tasting & Competition and Awards.

***April 18-20 is the Uniquely West Virginia Festival, including a wine and food fair at the state park.

(updates continued)

UTILITIES COMMITTEE

Gale Connor

I think that the Rock-Springs Mountainside Association is a more appropriate name for our community. Since starting the upgrade to our water system, we have seen more rocks and underground springs than we would have ever thought.

Yes, that mess that you have seen on Mountainside Road is the result of installing our new water line. If you think that progress on this project has been slow you are right. Delays have become a way of life. There are times we feel that we will never finish; but it will be finished. Rain, snow, rocks, springs, hunting season have all contributed to the slow pace.

The good news is that we feel this project will come in under budget. At this point our guesstimate is that $50,000 or more will be saved.

When you see Lee Weinberger, please take a moment to thank him for all the time and hard work that he has put into the water system upgrade. THANKS LEE!

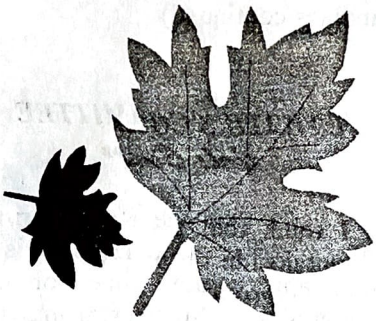
NOMINATING COMMITTEE

Dick Lehman

The committee has been charged by the Board to review past paractice and to propose new CMA election proceedures for Board approval early this year. Pending

(continued on page 8)

(committee updates continued)



LEAVES AND GUTTERS

Joan Bradfield

Do you hate having to get the ladder out and clean all those dirty, rotting leaves from your gutters? Or worse, paying somebody to do it?

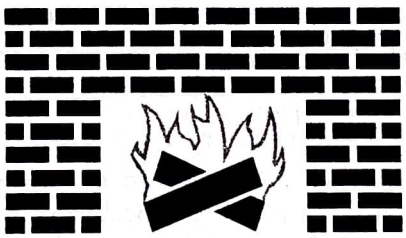
I recently had the Perma Flow Gutter Guard System installed at my home in Rockville, MD by Henry's Housework of Germantown. Henry Bockman, the owner, will be installing the same system at my home at Coolfont. In order to make his trip worthwhile, I thought other homeowners might also be interested. He is fully licensed and insured. If 3 or more homes are done, it will cost $3.20 per linear foot, which is slightly less than I paid. Call me, 301-984-9657) if you are interested or want more information.

For any "do-it-yourselfers", I understand from Carroll Yingling, that this material may also be purchased from Home Depot.

SOCIAL COMMITTEE

Joan Bradfield

A "telephone tree" is in effect as of the beginning of the year. Here's how it works: You should receive a phone call, probably monthly, informing you of events happening on the Mountainside. If you are in the US and the immediate area of Coolfont and not getting a call, please let Joan Bradfield know (301-984-9657). Our 25th Anniversary is fast approaching and plans are underway. Please call Eva Lehman (301-229-3264) with ideas, suggestions or if you want to help.



CHIMNEY SWEEP SERVICE

The constant use of a fire in your fireplace can cause a build up of creosote. If not cleaned regularly, chimney fires can happen. Please make sure that you have your chimney cleaned regularly.

A number of homeowners have been satisfied with the services of Appalachian Sweeps. If in need of competent knowledgeable service, contact them at Route 3, Box 255T, Hedgesville, WV 25427 304-754-9514. Mike Hamilton will be glad to help you.

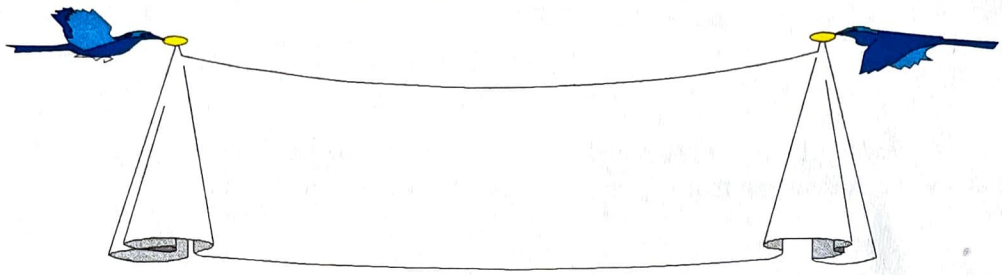
WHOLE HOUSE WATER FILTERS

Alice Minnamon

Twenty homeowners have found that a water filter attached to the pipe where water enters the home is helpful in filtering sediment and other tiny particles that occasionally show up in the water. Outages, due to mechanical failure, or broken pipes, cause agitation in reservoirs and on the inside lining of pipes that have collected sediment over time.

If you are interested in adding this feature to your home, Hunter's Hardware in Berkeley Springs, sells the filter container for $60 and Dawson's Hardware in Berkeley Springs sells one for $75. The filters are usually replaced every 3 months, or more often if the system has been shut down. The filters cost anywhere from $6 to $30 for a pack of two. The cost depends on how fine the particles are you want removed from the water.

John Hobday, CMA's maintenance person, will install the filter system for a reasonable charge. Give him a call at 304-258-8141 if you are interested.



10 NEW HOMES COMING IN MARCH

A new section of the Mountainside is set to open this Spring. Get your hammer and nails and come on down and join us on the ground floor in the building of these houses. What are we talking about? These homes use the latest technology, no plumbing, no electricity, no gas, no roads, no trees are cut down. These are BLUEBIRD HOUSES!. We are going to be getting a number of kits from the Audobon Society at a cost of $12 per kit. Anyone wishing to donate towards the cost of a house, or would like to try their hand at carpentry to build one of these houses, please contact either Charlie Balkan or Elmer Broxson by the second week in February. These houses need to be finished and set up by the first week of March in order for the blue birds to come.

GUIDELINES FOR BUILDING AT COOLFONT AMENDMENT

Please note the following Amendment to Section II 2 "Regulations & Guidelines for Building at Coolfont".

FIRE PREVENTION: Add to paragraph 1: "Homeowners are reminded that regular chimney cleanouts to remove creosote buildup are essential to prevent dangerous chimney fires." (see article on page 6.)

Amend Paragraph 2: "No exterior fires are permitted except charcoal cooking fires in barbecue receptacles."

Welcome

Let'sall welcome David Andleman & Katherine Smiley to the Mountainside. They purchased G-4 from Francis & Anne Stevens. Their address is: 3121 North 4th Street Arlington, VA 22201 home phone: 703-528-3151

BOARD OF DIRECTORS MEETINGS

Tim Black

At its November and January meetings the Board discussed a wide range of issues including.....

WATER/SEWER UPGRADE

The Board is closely following the implementation of the water/sewer upgrade under the able management of Lee Weinberger and Gale Connor. Good progress is being made though work has been virtually brought to a halt recently by winter weather. Due to various cost-saving measures the work is presently well under budget.

(continued on page 8)

(board minutes continued)

DACC

The Board is reviewing the proper role and functioning of the DACC in overseeing construction on the mountainside and will be discussing those issues with Committee Chair Linda Clark.

FIRE SAFETY

The Board remains concerned about the issue of fire safety on the Mountainside. The Board has further clarified its policy on open fires and has made recommendations for regular chimney cleaning as reported elsewhere in this issue of the newsletter.

POOL AND TENNIS COURTS

The Board is discussing with the Recreation Committee (chaired by Charlie Balkan) procedures for admission to the pool. They are also looking into having the tennis court contractor correct problems with the court surfaces.

BARN

The Board is considering how the barn can be put to good use for social events, cultural activities etc, as well as physical improvements and repairs that are necessary.

The Board welcomes suggestions from members on these and other matters. The next Board meeting will be on February 8, 1997 at the Yingling residence at Coolfont, and as usual, will be open to all. The pot luck dinner will be held at the Bains in the evening.

(continued from page 5 updates)

appointment of Committee members, CMA members are invited to send any ideas for improving the election process to Dick Lehman, Nomination Committee Chairman. The committee will work on the revised election procedures during February and have them ready in final form for Board consideration at its March 1997 meeting. The two-year terms of three of the seven CMA Board members will expire in July 1997, so the Committee anticipates the need this spring to provide official nominations for three vacated seats that will be filled by balloting at the annual meeting. CMA members are encouraged to begin thinking about qualified candidates for these seats, and to submit names to committee members. Names of the Nomination Committee members approved at the February 8 board meeting will be published in the next issue of this newsletter.

If you have any ideas, suggestions or would like to send us an article, please send it to
Mary Ann Siushansian
17302 Parson Grove Terrace
Olney, MD 20832
We would really love to hear your comments and/or ideas.